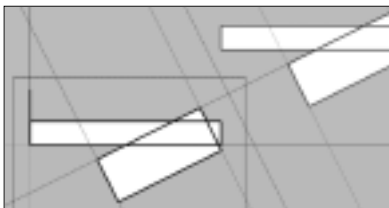


the step you're editing. You'll now have to choose a reference line—click on the bottom edge to select it as a reference line. Now click on the midpoint of the bottom edge of the step above to create the guide. If the guide didn't appear, you'll need to use [Ctrl] to toggle guides and repeat.

Once you have this guide in place, you'll need to create one that's perpendicular to it. Use the same reference point, and choose the first guide as your reference line. *Make sure you move the new guide away from the midpoint of the edge when you're done.* Enter 90 in the VCB and hit [Enter]. It helps to use the Left or Right view with Parallel Projection turned on here. Create enough guides to aid you in drawing a rectangle using the Line tool.



Draw a rectangle using the guides

Move the new rectangle away from the step just a little bit, and then use the Push tool to turn it into a box. You can get rid of the guides (Edit > Delete Guides) if you want. Now use the Push tool to increase the length of the box, such that the boxes from each component touch each other. Move this box up a bit, and your stringer's done!



The stairway with the completed stringer

As you can see, while the Component method requires a lot of work, it's always worth it.

4.3 Roof On Our Heads

Every house needs a roof, and these structures come in various shapes and sizes. You can have the typical sloping roof you've drawn in so many nursery drawings (called a *gabled* roof), go the pointy gothic way, or stick with the simple flat roof with a parapet.